DANIELLE SCHMIDT-LARIOS

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EDUCATION

Exp. 2027 PhD, Sociology/Community & Environmental Sociology, University of Wisconsin-Madison

Dissertation: Spatiotemporalities of Agricultural Land Loss: A multi-scalar and mixed-methods analysis of agricultural land transitions out of production

Committee: Katherine J. Curtis (chair) – Community & Environmental Sociology
Sarah Rios (hon. co-chair) – Environmental Studies, Cal Poly Humboldt
Samer Alatout – Community & Environmental Sociology
Tessa Conroy – Ag & Applied Economics/Extension Specialist
Nan Enstad – Community & Environmental Sociology
Amanda McMillan Lequieu – Sociology, Drexel University

Prelim. Exams: Environmental Sociology (passed with distinction)
Sociology of Agrifood Systems

Minor: Geography

2023 MS, Community & Environmental Sociology, University of Wisconsin-Madison

Thesis: Towards an Emplaced Vocabulary of Motive: Understanding the decision-making processes of agricultural landholders in the Upper Missouri River Breaks

2019 AB, Philosophy, Public Policy Studies (honors), The University of Chicago

Minor: Human Rights

PUBLICATIONS*

Boyce, Mckenzie, Yang Cheng, Erin Gaede, and **Danielle Schmidt-Larios**. [Forthcoming]. "Measuring Rural Livability: Challenges, Choices, and Considerations." In *Redefining Community Development Through Rural Livability*, edited by Tessa Conroy and Steven Deller. Community Development Series, Routledge.

Boyce, Mckenzie, **Danielle Schmidt-Larios,** Erin Gaede, and Yang Cheng. 2027. "The Community Capitals for Quantitative Research: Data, Directions, and Debates," *Journal of Rural Studies* 129. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jrurstud.2026.104487.

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle. 2026. "Land through three approaches." *Agriculture and Human Values*, 43(35). https://doi.org/10.1007/s10460-026-10853-1.

Schmidt, Danielle, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller. 2025. "Prosperity Across the United States: Revisiting the Isserman, Feser, and Warren Prosperity Index Using Sequence Analysis." *International Regional Science Review* 49(2): 147–78. https://doi.org/10.1177/01600176251377424.
*winner of the Ron Wimberly Award from the Rural Sociological Society

* Published as "Danielle Schmidt" prior to 2026.

Schmidt, Danielle. 2024. "Towards an Emplaced Vocabulary of Motive: Senses of Place and Land Sale Decision-Making in the Northern Great Plains." *Rural Sociology*, 89(4), 975-995. https://doi.org/10.1111/ruso.12574.

Schmidt, Danielle. 2023. "Farming for sociologists: A new key text for rural sociologists." *Journal of Agriculture, Food Systems, and Community Development*, 12(4), 1–2. https://doi.org/10.5304/jafscd.2023.124.004

Schmidt, Danielle and Séamus A. Power. 2020. "Offline World: The Internet as Social Infrastructure among the Unconnected in Quasi-Rural Illinois." *Integrative Psychological and Behavioral Science*, 55(2), 371-385. https://doi.org/10.1007/s12124-020-09574-9.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PROGRESS

Under review

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle and Katherine J. Curtis. "Leaving 'Cowboy Ethnography' in the Dust and Advancing the Practice of Collaborative Ethnography," *Sociological Methods and Research*

Boyce, Mckenzie, Tessa Conroy, and **Danielle Schmidt-Larios**. "A Fork in the Road: How Measurement Decisions Shape Narratives of Livability and Can Misrepresent Rural Places," *Annals of Regional Science*

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle, Amanda McMillan Lequieu, and Katherine J. Curtis. 2027. "Home in a Changing Climate." In *A Global Assessment of Sociology's Contributions to the Climate Emergency*, Routledge. [Invited by the International Sociological Association]

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle, Mckenzie Boyce, and Tessa Conroy. "Borrowing Natural Capital: Assessing the value of spatially shared natural amenities on local quality of life," *Ecological Economics*

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle and Sarah Rios**.** "Wildfires in the Workplace: A Survey of Latinx Farmworkers," *Journal of Environmental Studies and Sciences*

In preparation

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle. "Former Farms: Quantifying, classifying, and assessing agricultural land loss in the post-Farm Crisis era," *Land Use Policy*

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle and Katherine J. Curtis. "To Lose One's Place: Confronting environmental and community change on the Northern Great Plains," *Rural Sociology*

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle and Sarah Rios**.** "The manufactured precarity of farm work," in *Handbook of Environmental Racism*, edited by Michael Mascarenhas, Julie Sze, Alex Huezo, Stephen Gasteyer, and Diana Ojeda. Anthem Press. [Abstract accepted/chapter invited]

Avila, Elisa, Katherine J. Curtis, and **Danielle Schmidt-Larios**. "Place-based Framework for in-depth interviews across the Rural-Urban Continuum," *Qualitative Inquiry*

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle. "Constructing the Myth of Wilderness, from Gilded Age to Gilded Age," *Environmental History*

Book Manuscript

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle. *Reserved for whom? (Re)Making Home, Place, and Identity on Rural Landscapes* [Proposal for advance contract in preparation]

OUTREACH & PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle, Mckenzie Boyce, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller. 2026. *WIndicator:* Sharing Livability: Assessing the Link Between Rural and Urban Prosperity [Technical report]. University of Wisconsin–Madison Division of Extension. https://doi.org/10.21231/mwem-5533

Schmidt, Danielle, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller. 2025. "Pathways to Prosperity: Moving Beyond Growth to Evaluate Change in Community Well-Being." *Choices Magazine* 40 (2). https://www.choicesmagazine.org/choices-magazine/submitted-articles/pathways-to-prosperity-moving-beyond-growth-to-evaluate-change-in-community-well-being [peer reviewed]

Schmidt, Danielle, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller. 2025. *WIndicator:* Understanding Wisconsin prosperity in the national context [Technical report]. University of Wisconsin–Madison Division of Extension. https://doi.org/10.21231/BRBW-6V80

Curtis, Katherine J., **Danielle D. Schmidt**, and John C. Canfield. "Views on the Land." *Phillips County News*, May 22, 2024. https://www.phillipscountynews.com/story/2024/05/22/opinion/views-on-the-land/15471.html

Rios, Sarah and **Danielle Schmidt.** 2023. "Survey Summary: A summary of farmworker responses to experiencing wildfires in the workplace." Prepared for *Líderes Campesinas en California*. https://liderescampesinas.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/10/F.I.R.E-Report-1030-.pdf

Schmidt, Danielle. "Letter: Tyson the Bison and the Future of Farming." *Daily Herald*, May 14, 2022. https://www.dailyherald.com/discuss/20220514/letter-tyson-the-bison-and-the-future-of-farming

Curtis, Katherine J., John C. Canfield, and **Danielle D. Schmidt.** 2021. "A Report on Population and Ag Production in Phillips County, Montana." https://apl.wisc.edu/shared/conservation-agriculture-rural/phillips-county

AWARDS & HONORS

May 2026	John Harrison Kolb Memorial Scholarship Award for *exceptional intellectual contributions, academic achievements, and professional involvement*, Dept. of Community & Environmental Sociology, UW-Madison
Apr. 2026	Calvin L. Beale Graduate Award for *perpetuating the belief that understanding the people behind the statistics is the very essence of sociological research*, Dept. of Sociology, UW-Madison
Mar. 2025	Ronald Wimberley Graduate Student Paper Competition for *making a strong contribution to our understanding of rural community life and health*, Community, Health, and Family Research Interest Group, Rural Sociological Society
Nov. 2023	Honored Instructor for *positive impact on students,* University Housing (**student nominated**), UW-Madison
Jun. 2019	Richard P. Taub Prize for *best thesis*, Dept. of Public Policy, The University of Chicago
Nov. 2018	Abraham Lincoln Civic Engagement Award for *leadership and service in the pursuit of the betterment of humanity*, UChicago Recipient, The Lincoln Academy of Illinois

COMPETITIVE RESEARCH FUNDING

May 2026	Grad Student "Small Grant" Competition, Dept. of Sociology, UW-Madison, **$390**
May 2025	Summer Mini-Grant, Center for Integrated Agricultural Systems (CIAS), **$2,991.80**

May 2025	Graduate Student Grant, North-Central Region SARE, *not funded*
Mar. 2025	Dissertation Research Award, Rural Sociological Society, **$2,800**
Oct. 2024	Predoctoral Fellowship, USDA NIFA AFRI, *not funded*
May 2024	Evelyn T. Crowe Scholarship – Pre-Dissertation Research, Dept. of Community & Environmental Sociology, UW-Madison, **$2,585**
May 2022	Evelyn T. Crowe Scholarship – Master's Thesis Research, Dept. of Community & Environmental Sociology, UW-Madison, **$5,000**
Mar. 2022	Grad Student "Small Grant" Competition, Dept. of Sociology, UW-Madison, **$165**

RESEARCH POSITIONS

Appointments

2024 - *Graduate Research Assistant*, UW-Madison Agriculture & Applied Economics
Wisconsin Rural Partnership Initiative: The Rural Livability Project
Professor Tessa Conroy, Primary Investigator

2021-23 *Graduate Research Assistant*, UW-Madison Community & Environmental Sociology
Crisis and Adaptation: How Wildfires Change the Agricultural Workplace
Professor Sarah M. Rios, Primary Investigator

2020-21 *State Research Assistantship*, UW-Madison Community & Environmental Sociology
Conflict at the Intersection of Production and Conservation
Professor Katherine J. Curtis, Supervisor

Contracts

Spring 2026 *GIS data visualization*, Economic impact of hospitals on the Wisconsin economy
Professor Steven Deller (Emeritus, UW-Madison)

Spring 2025 *Qualitative data collection*, Rural Informal Work in economically, socially, culturally, and technologically changing contexts
Professor Emily Wornell (Ball State), Primary Investigator; Professors Amanda McMillan Lequieu (Drexel) and Jean Hardy (Michigan State), Supervisors

TEACHING POSITIONS

Appointments

Fall 2023 TA, SOC 125: *American Society: How It Really Works*, UW-Madison Dept of Sociology
37 students; 4.86/5 mean overall student evaluation (department mean 4.45/5)

Spring 2023 TA, ILS 200: *Critical Thinking & Expression*, UW-Madison Integrated Liberal Studies
34 students; mode score 5/5 across all student evaluation questions

Service & Mentorship

2026 -	Supervisor, Undergraduate Research Assistant for the Rural Livability Project
2025-26	Capstone Project "Expert," Dept. of Agriculture and Applied Economics, UW-Madison
2024-25	ESL Instructor (Adult Education), Madison International Partners
2024-26	Research Mentor, AP Capstone Research, Mentor Matching Engine

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

Oct. 2026	"Reserved for whom?" *Environment, Natural Resources, and Society*, UW-Madison [Guest lecture]
Sep. 2026	"Deep Mapping Change in Human-Land Relations on the Northern Great Plains," Symposium of the National Endowment for the Humanities (NEH) Community Deep Mapping Institute (CDMI), held in Sumter, South Carolina
Apr. 2026	"Reserved: The transition of production agricultural land to conservation reserves across two cases," Michigan Technological University Dept. of Social Sciences
Nov. 2025	"Reserved for whom?" *Conservation Biology*, Williams College [Guest lecture]
Oct. 2025	"Reserved for whom?" *Environment, Natural Resources, and Society*, UW-Madison [Guest lecture]
Oct. 2025	"Cowboy Ethnography: Challenges of and strategies for collaborative spatial data collection and community engaged methods in the twenty-first century," American Philosophical Society International Symposium on the Future of Fieldwork, held in Philadelphia, PA (*view recording here*)
Jun. 2025	"What Makes a Place 'Livable'?" Connecting Entrepreneurial Communities, held in Wisconsin Rapids, WI (*view presentation slides here*)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Nov. 2026	"Constructing the Myth of the Wilderness: Examining the sociopolitical process of creating conservation reserves," Social Science History Association; Atlanta, GA
Aug. 2026	"Borrowing Natural Capital: Assessing the value of spatially shared natural amenities on local livability," Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Raleigh, NC
Aug. 2026	"Negotiating Salvation: Conflict in Conservation," Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Raleigh, NC
Nov. 2025	"Former Farms, Future Farming: Quantifying, classifying, and assessing agricultural land loss in the post-Farm Crisis era using remote sensing and administrative data," North American Regional Science Council Annual Meeting; Denver, CO
Jul. 2025	"Former Farms, Future Farming: Quantifying, classifying, and assessing agricultural land loss in the post-Farm Crisis era using remote sensing and administrative data," Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Salt Lake City, UT
Jul. 2025	"The Spatial Diffusion of Rural Livability Across the Urban-Rural Interface," Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Salt Lake City, UT
Jul. 2025	"To Lose One's Place: Confronting environmental and community change on the Northern Great Plains," International Sociological Association; Rabat, Morocco
Mar. 2025	"The Spatial Diffusion of Rural Livability Across the Urban-Rural Interface," American Association of Geographers; Detroit, MI
Jul. 2024	"To Lose One's Place: Confronting environmental and community change on the Northern Great Plains," Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Madison, WI
Nov. 2023	"Wildfires in the Workplace: Understanding the manufactured precarity of farm work in a changing climate," Social Science History Association Annual Conference; Washington, D.C.

Apr. 2023	"Pricing the Prairie: Large-Scale Conservation and Early-Stage Rural Gentrification in a Western Agricultural Community," Population Assoc. of America; New Orleans, LA
Nov. 2022	"A Done Deed: The Socially Contentious Decision to Sell Production Land," Social Science History Association Annual Conference; Chicago, IL
Jul. 2021	"'Save the Cowboy': Large-Scale Conservation and Early-Stage Rural Gentrification in a Western Agricultural Community," Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Virtual

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS & AFFILIATIONS

Rural Sociological Society; Social Science History Association; American Association of Geographers

SERVICE TO DEPARTMENT & PROFESSION

2025-26	Member, Awards and Endowment Committee, Rural Sociological Society
2023-25	Co-Chair, Rural, Ag, and Environmental Network, Social Science History Association
2023	Organizing Committee, UW Agroecology Symposium: "Relationships for Change"
2022	Graduate Student Rep., Ethics Committee, Rural Sociological Society
2020-22	Member, Culture & Climate Committee, UW-Madison Sociology Grad Student Assoc.

REFEREE EXPERIENCE

Journals: *Agriculture and Human Values; International Journal of Sociology of Agriculture and Food; Review of Regional Studies*

Books: *Redefining Community Development Through Rural Livability*

Grants: Rural Sociological Society; North Central Sustainable Agriculture and Research Education

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software:	R, ArcGIS (Pro, StoryMaps), Qualtrics, NVivo
Languages:	English (native), Spanish (limited working proficiency)
Certifications:	(Farmer-oriented) Mental Health First Aid, UW-Madison Research Mentor Badge

REFERENCES

Katherine J. Curtis
Buttel-Sewell Professor
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Director, Center for Demography & Ecology
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